

XP Exercises

Understanding Claude and the Power of Interfaces — Submission Template

Name Rogério Froiman	Date 17/08/2026	Instructor Max
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Scenario reminder (fictional): Maple & Finch is a 40-person market-research agency. Dana's Monday: 20 transcripts to summarise, a competitor round-up, receipts to organise, and a client update email — all currently done through a chatbot.

Exercise 1 — Find the Overhang

Field	Your answer
Task chosen	Summarising 20 customer-interview transcripts
Where the chat box creates friction	Dana has to paste each transcript in one at a time (or in chunks that fit context), wait for a reply, copy it out into a separate document, and repeat this 20 times — losing track of which transcripts she's already done and re-explaining the summary format each time.
What a better interface would do	Take the whole folder of 20 transcripts as input and return one finished, consistently-formatted summary document.

Exercise 2 — Match the Interface

For each task, choose the best interface (Claude chat app, Cowork, or Dispatch) and give a one-line reason.

Task	Best interface	Why
1 — Summarise 20 transcripts into one document	Cowork	It's a bulk file-processing job on Dana's own files — better handled by an agent working directly on the folder than pasted piece by piece into chat.
2 — Quick: a good subject line for a client update	Claude chat app	It's a single, self-contained question with no files or multi-step work — a normal conversational answer is fastest.
3 — Organise receipts into an expense report	Cowork	It requires reading multiple files, extracting data, and assembling a structured output — a file-based agent task, not a back-and-forth chat.
4 — Kick off the competitor round-up while commuting	Dispatch	Dana isn't at her desk; Dispatch lets her start and steer a Cowork-style research task from her phone.

Exercise 3 — Write a Brief, Not a Prompt

Task to brief: draft Maple & Finch's weekly client update email.

Field	Your answer
Goal	Draft this week's client update email summarising project progress and next steps for Maple & Finch's active clients.
Context	Pull from this week's interview summaries and the competitor round-up; use the tone and structure of last week's client update (attached) as a reference.
Constraints	Keep it under 300 words, no internal jargon, and flag any client-specific numbers for Dana to verify before sending.
Definition of done	A ready-to-send draft with subject line, saved as a document Dana can review and edit — not sent automatically.

Exercise 4 — Learn From a Real Use Case

USE CASE (real, sourced): Paweł Huryn ran Claude Dispatch for 48 hours and directed 60+ task sessions from his phone. Source: productcompass.pm/p/claude-dispatch-guide

Field	Your answer
Interface that made it possible	Dispatch — it let Huryn start, check on, and steer 60+ agent sessions from his phone throughout the day.
Why a chatbot couldn't do the same	A chatbot needs Huryn present and typing in real time for each exchange; it can't run work in the background while he's away from a screen or hold many parallel task threads at once.

Concept it illustrates (and how)	Parallel work — instead of one linear conversation, Huryñ directed many independent task sessions simultaneously, closing the capability overhang between what the AI could do and what a single chat thread could surface.
One honest limitation	The actual work still ran on desktop sessions (Cowork) — Dispatch is a remote control, not where the computation happens, so a working desktop environment was still required behind the scenes.